

Once
you stop
learning,
you start
dying.

—Albert Einstein

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to the high cost of hardware such as Nvidia GPUs, stressing that organisations must invest mindfully in infrastructure, whether in the cloud or on-premises, to enable agent AI effectively.

From a technological perspective, Gaurav Gupta observes that digitally mature companies with exposed APIs and well-structured data can adopt agents more quickly. In contrast, organisations with siloed and complex systems may struggle. He highlights growing frameworks such as AutoGPT, Crew.ai, and LangGraph, along with platforms hosting thousands of agents, which are making agent deployment increasingly accessible. “Most companies will eventually need to adopt such systems,” he notes.

Regulatory readiness, however, remains a moving target. Sunil Mishra and Dr Kurien highlight the pace of AI innovation, observing that regulation often lags behind technological breakthroughs. “The pace is such that regulators are struggling to keep up,” Mishra says. Dr Kurien adds that while timely regulation could accelerate progress, India still trails Europe, China, and the US, which have more mature AI regulatory frameworks. Clearer and more timely regulations, he argues, could help accelerate technological advancement.

Individual readiness also demands a shift in mindset. Dr Kurien compares the current phase to earlier technological transitions, from bullock carts to cars, noting that fear of obsolescence is natural but often misplaced. Humans adapt, regulate, and retain control. With agent AI, the paradigm shifts: humans increasingly augment AI, rather than AI merely augmenting humans.

The panellists also share notable real-world applications that illustrate both scale and speed. Gaurav points to autonomous financial agents analysing stocks, healthcare agents supporting diagnosis, and marketing agents reducing multi-day

lead-generation cycles to hours. Sonia envisages personal ‘copilots’ capable of managing emails, synthesising documents, and handling routine managerial tasks, allowing humans to focus on higher-value work.

Cost and accessibility are also a major discussion point. While operating advanced models remains expensive, panellists note that competition and innovation in chipsets and cloud infrastructure are steadily driving costs down. They cite examples such as DeepSeek, which has innovated under constraints to deliver powerful AI using less resource-intensive setups. Sonia draws a parallel with mobile phone adoption, suggesting that as AI infrastructure becomes more affordable and accessible, broader adoption will follow.

The discussion concludes by addressing the challenge of keeping pace with rapid breakthroughs while remaining productive. Sunil Mishra offers a pragmatic perspective: “AI has gone mainstream. Five years ago, it was primarily used by data scientists. ChatGPT was a Netscape moment for AI, it made the technology accessible. New models and updates now emerge every week, making continuous learning essential. The era when a single degree was sufficient is over; ongoing learning is now part of working life.”

He reassures the audience that these advances are likely to improve efficiency, reduce costs, and free up human time, suggesting that the broader trajectory remains positive. **EFY**

*This article is based on insights from the panel discussion “Autonomous Agents: What’s Ready? Who’s Ready? Are You Ready?”, held on March 27, 2025 at the EFY AI DevCon India 2025, Nimhans Convention Centre, Bengaluru. The session brought together experts including Srivathsa NS, Senior Engineering Director, Unisys; Sunil Mishra, Author and Curator, The Product Way; Gaurav Gupta, Principal Engineer, Unisys; Dr Devasia K., Founder and Managing Director, *astTECS; and Sonia Taneja, Senior Engineering Manager, Nutanix. The discussion was transcribed and curated by Shubha Mitra, Assistant Editor, EFY.*